

SHOWCASE

THOMPSON SUBMACHINE-GUN MODEL 1928

This iconic submachine-gun shot to fame because of its use by gangsters such as “Machine-gun Kelly” before attaining respectability in the hands of US military and federal agencies. Recoil-operated (see p.305), this weapon could fire either single shots or continuously in automatic mode, at a rate of 600–700 rounds per minute. A devastating weapon at close quarters, it employed the powerful .45in ACP cartridge.



▲ CUTTS COMPENSATOR

The Cutts Compensator, a device designed by Richard Cutts in 1926, is screwed onto the muzzle. Unlike a regular muzzle compensator, it consists of a cylinder with slots in its upper half to divert the muzzle blast upward and force the muzzle downward. This prevents the muzzle from rising, especially when the gun is fired in automatic mode.

▲ BARREL ASSEMBLY AND RECEIVER

The barrel fits into the receiver. It features fins that radiate heat and cool it during operation. The receiver is a hollow steel channel that holds the sliding bolt assembly.

Flat key for winding the internal spiral magazine spring

Forward pistol grip is mounted in front of the receiver

◀ DRUM MAGAZINE

For this gun, 50- and 100-round drum magazines were available to provide extended fire capability. To load a new cartridge into a magazine, the magazine had to be dismantled and then wound like a clock, compressing the internal spiral magazine spring.